

JDM Connect Vehicle Finder — How-To Guide

A plain-English walkthrough of the whole site: what every screen does, and how to get your day-to-day jobs done. Screenshots are from the live app.

- **Public site:** jdmfinder.com.au
 - **Sign in:** jdmfinder.com.au/login
-

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1. Who uses the site

There are four kinds of login, and the site shows each one only what they need:

Role	Who	What they see
Admin	You (JDM Connect)	Everything: every customer, request, match, agent, payment and setting.
Agent	A partner who finds cars for their own buyers	Only the customers assigned or shared to them, and those customers' searches and matches.
Customer (buyer)	The end buyer	The buyer portal : the cars found for them and the searches you're running.
Dealer	A trade partner submitting vehicles	The dealer portal (vehicle submissions & review).

Rule of thumb: an agent can only see a customer if that customer is **assigned to them as Owner** or **shared** with them. A customer you create yourself is owned by "JDM Connect" and is invisible to agents until you assign or share them.

2. The public site & customer signup

The landing page

The public homepage explains the service and pushes visitors to start a search. The vehicle strip lower down shows **genuinely upcoming lots pulled live from the auction feed** (it hides itself if the feed has nothing to show, so it never displays stale cars).

— LIVE JAPANESE AUCTION ACCESS

Your dream car is at auction in Japan *right now.*

Tell us what you're after and start free. Or unlock full auction access for A\$49 a month and watch the floor yourself, with the real landed price and import eligibility on every lot.

[Start your search, free →](#)[See what's landing](#)

NO CARD TO START · CANCEL ANYTIME · MEMBERSHIP CREDITS TOWARD YOUR IMPORT FEE

SCROLL

**Chat with us**

Away - leave a message

T-R · GRADE 4 · ¥3,180,000 // LOT 2208 · GDB WRX STI · GRADE 4 · ¥1,420,000 // LOT 8814 · FD3S RX-7 · GRADE 4 · ¥5,420,000 // LOT 1067 · S15 SILVIA · GRAD

UNDER THE HOOD

01

40,000 listings, scanned daily.

USS, TAA and ASNET, every major Japanese auction house,
swept each morning before you've had your coffee.



— THE BIT NOBODY SHOWS YOU

**The auction price
is not the price.**

The bid, Japan-side fees, shipping, GST, compliance and

LANDED, TO YOUR DOOR

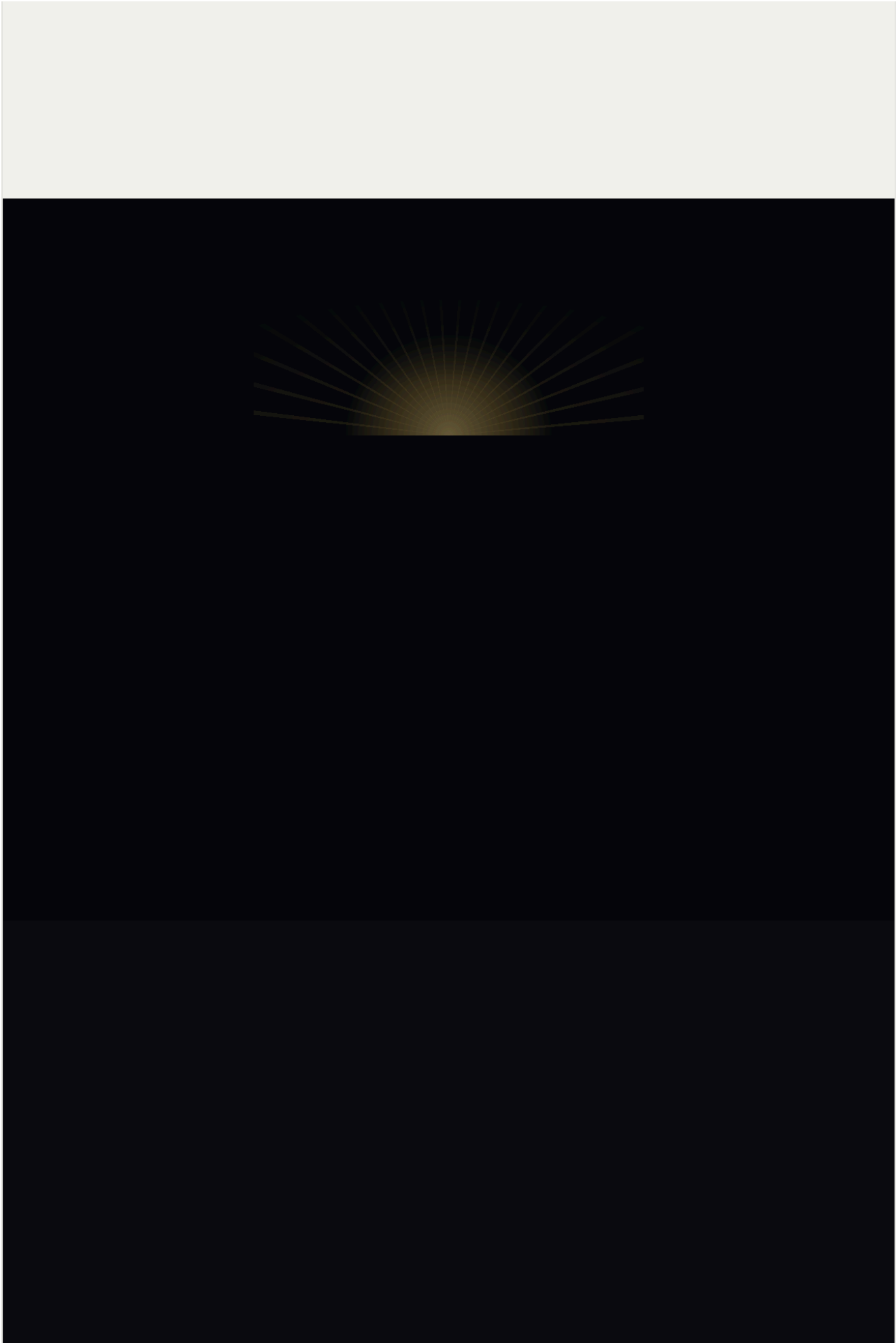
A\$0

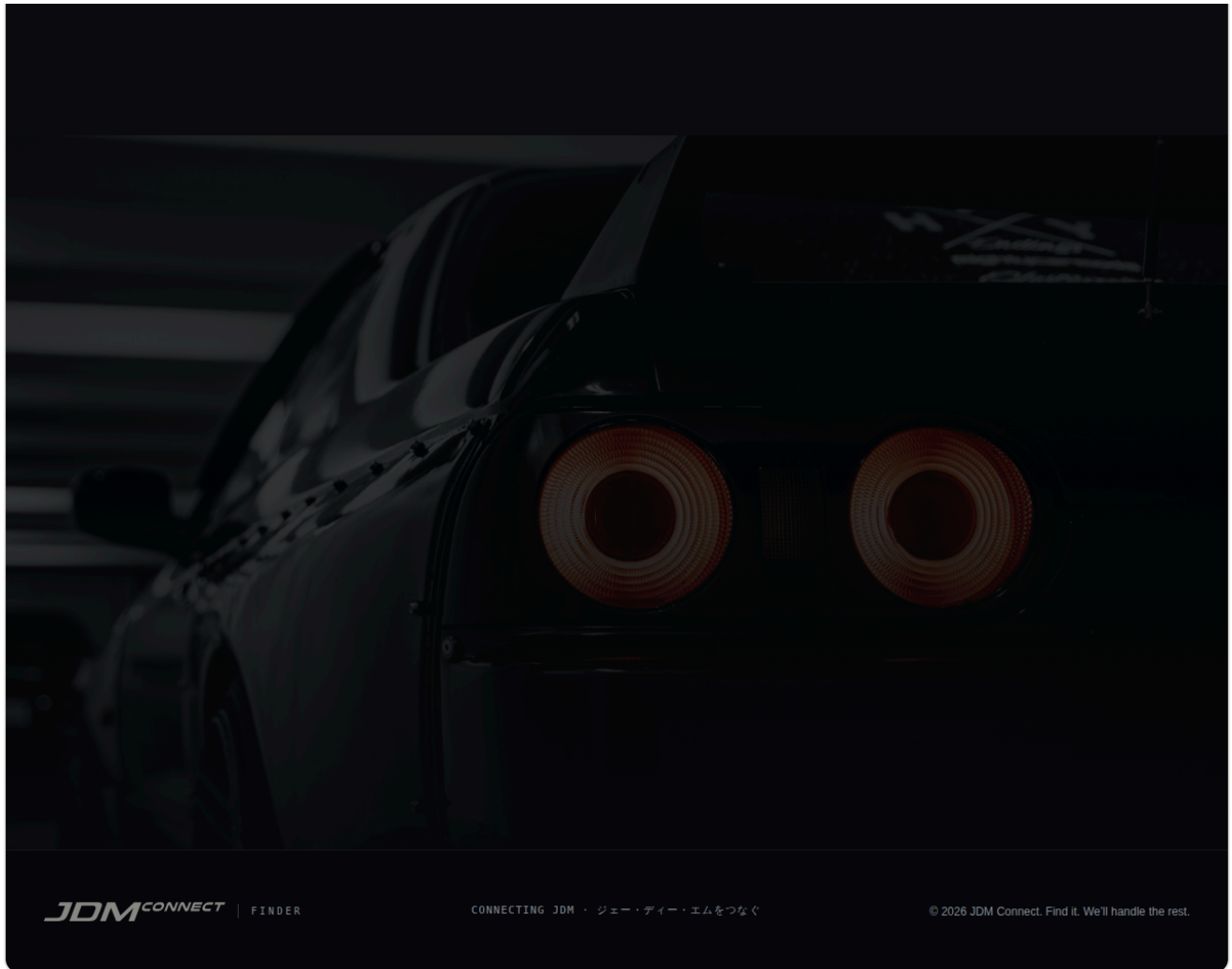
on-road costs, all the way to your door. We show the real number before you bid. Here's a worked example.

WORKED EXAMPLE · ¥5,000,000 BID · LANDED FREMANTLE, WA









JDMCONNECT | FINDER

CONNECTING JDM ・ ジェー・ディー・エムをつなぐ

© 2026 JDM Connect. Find it. We'll handle the rest.

The request wizard (how a customer signs up)

"Start free" / "Start a vehicle search" opens a four-step wizard. This is how every new customer and search enters the system.

JDM CONNECT | FINDER Sign in

1 Find car 2 Budget 3 Review 4 Account

POPULAR SEARCHES

- Toyota Alphard**
Luxury family mover
- Nissan Skyline**
Performance icon
- Toyota Crown**
Executive hybrid sedan
- GR Yaris**
Rally-bred hot hatch
- Toyota HiAce**
Legendary work van
- Corolla Touring**
Hybrid wagon

Nickname (optional, for your reference)
e.g. weekend project

Make
e.g. TOYOTA

Model
e.g. SUPRA

Year from
1990

Year to
2002

Refine my search (optional)
RECENTLY SOLD AT AUCTION
Choose a make and model above to see recent auction sales.

Next: your budget →

Chat with us
Away - leave a message

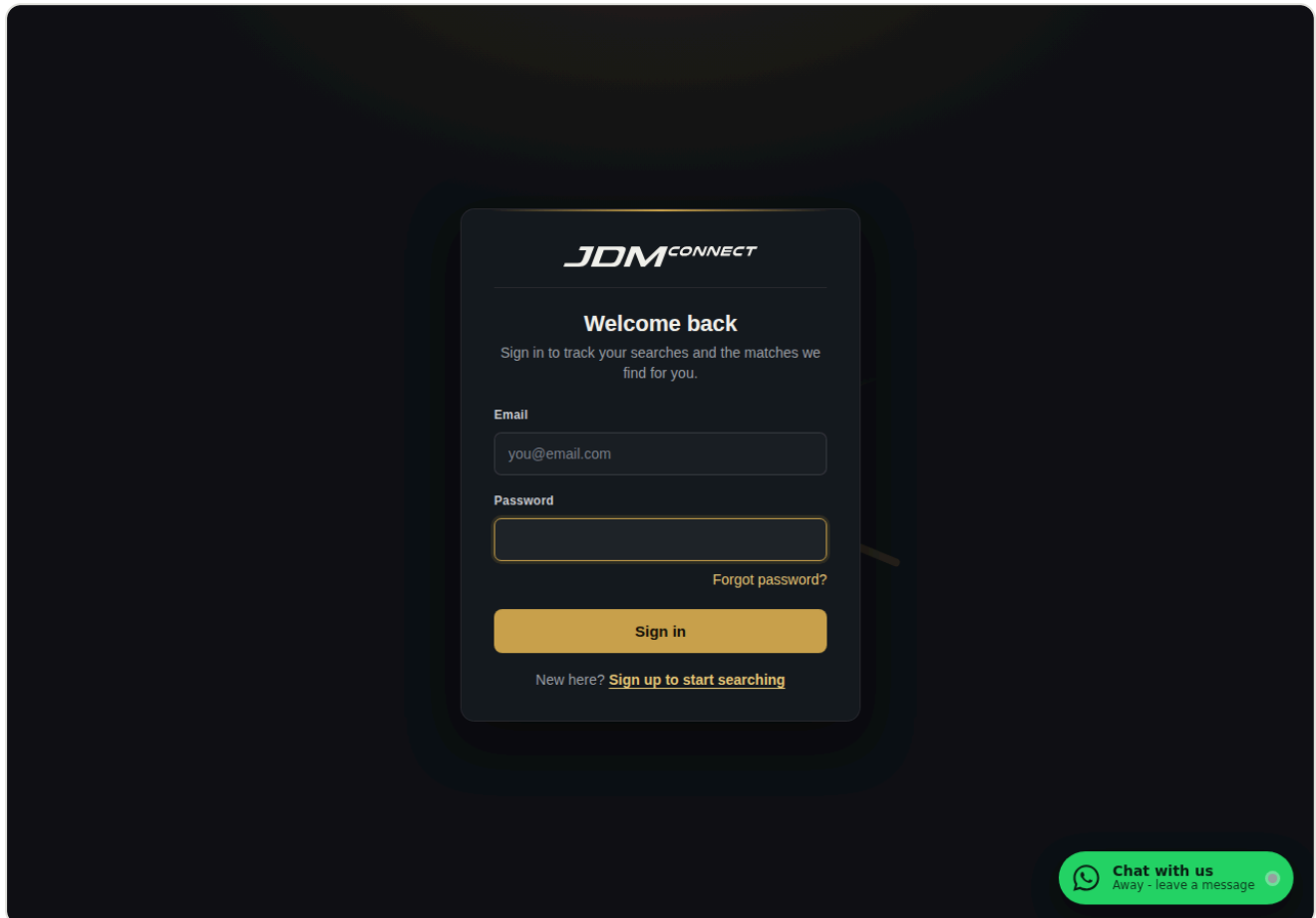
- Find car** — pick a popular preset or type a Make and Model, plus a year range. **Refine my search** adds optional filters: max mileage, minimum auction grade, chassis code, and the **Model code** and **Grade** pickers (see [Model codes](#)).
- Budget** — the customer's all-in AUD budget and their state/country.
- Review** — a summary of what they're chasing.
- Account** — email + password to create their login.

What happens after they submit:

- A new account is created and their search starts running against the auctions.
- If the email already has an account, we don't create a duplicate — we quietly email that inbox a sign-in link instead (so nobody can probe who's registered).
- Matches are **reviewed by staff before they're sent** (this is the default — see [Settings](#) → [Free tier](#)).

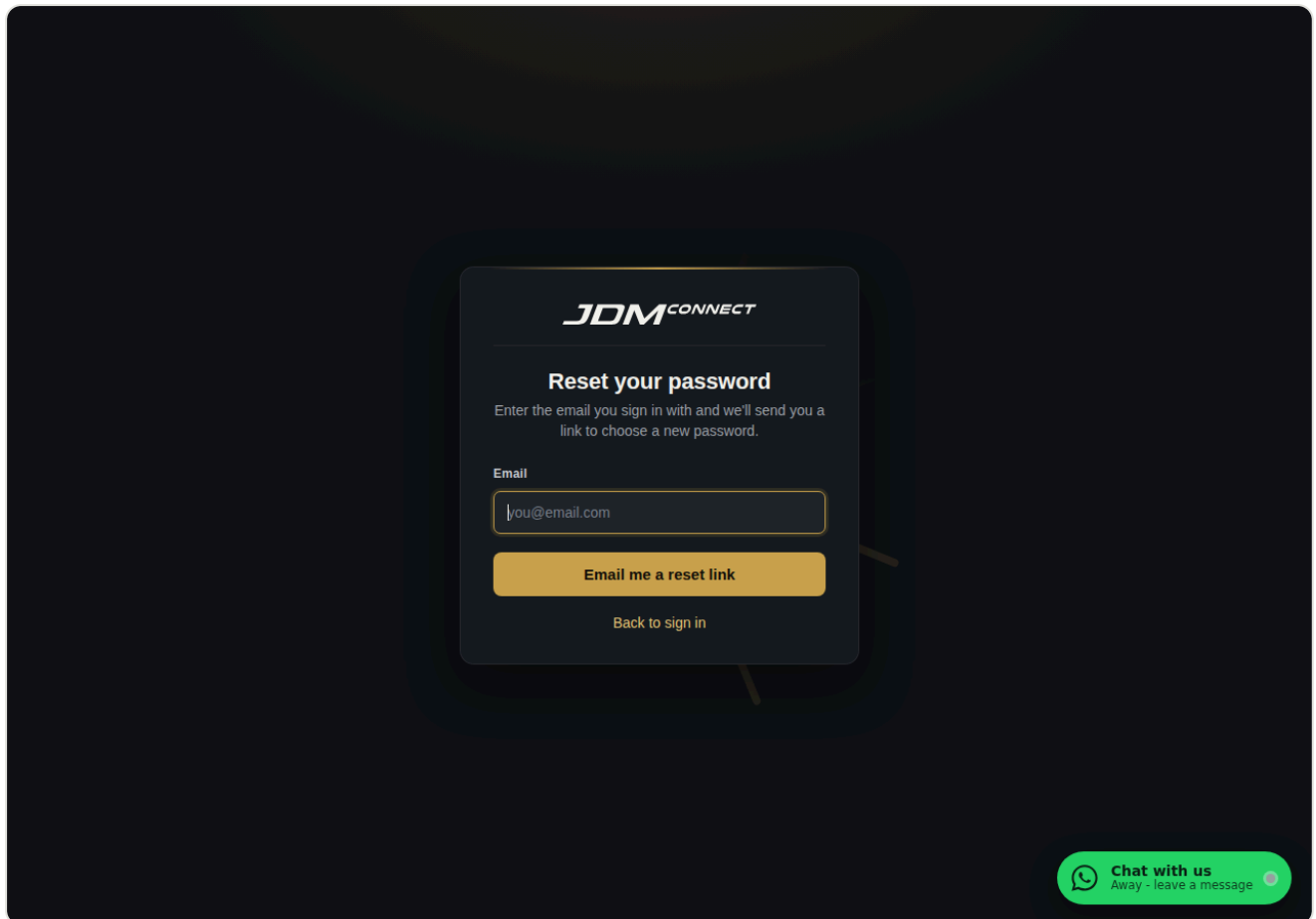
3. Signing in & resetting passwords

Everyone signs in at the same screen. Admins can leave the email blank and just enter the admin password; agents, customers and dealers use their email + password.

The image shows a dark-themed login interface for JDM Connect. At the top center is the JDM CONNECT logo. Below it, the text "Welcome back" is displayed, followed by a subtext: "Sign in to track your searches and the matches we find for you." There are two input fields: "Email" with the placeholder "you@email.com" and "Password". To the right of the password field is a link that says "Forgot password?". Below the inputs is a large orange "Sign in" button. At the bottom of the form, it says "New here? [Sign up to start searching](#)". In the bottom right corner of the overall screen, there is a green chat bubble that says "Chat with us" and "Away - leave a message".

Forgot password

Anyone can reset their own password from the **Forgot password?** link. They enter their email and receive a link (valid for 1 hour) to choose a new one.



The confirmation looks identical whether or not the email has an account, so the form can't be used to find out who's registered. You can also trigger a reset for someone from their record in the admin.

4. The admin dashboard

Your home screen — "what needs me today," answered. Everything is one tap away.

JDMCONNECT

Search customers, vehicle:

Dashboard

Requests7

Tasks

Matches3

Customers8

Auctions

Agents3

Payments

Settings

Run Searches

JDM ConnectADMIN

Sign out

JDM Connect, vehicle finder

Good morning,
Jate

NEEDS ATTENTION TODAY

6New leads to contact

0Closing in 48h

3Matches to review

0Follow-ups due

7Stalled requests

0Deposits outstanding

0Overdue tasks

0Tasks due today

6New

0Qualified

1Searching

0Vehicles sent

0Interested

0Deposit paid

0Purchased

0Delivered

Team overview

Manage

1Active clients

0Active agents

1Open requests

0Sent this week

0Members

Who needs attention today? (0)

Open

Nothing scheduled for today. You're clear.

Which auctions close today? (0)

Review

Nothing closing in the next 48h.

Who's gone quiet? (1)

Open

AT

Aiko Tanaka

1 opened · 1 interested

Quiet 20d ago

Which requests are stalled? (7)

Review

BT

Nissan Skyline

Ben Test · no activity

New

SS

Toyota Supra

Shared Sam · no activity

New

AT

Nissan Skyline

Aiko Tanaka · no activity

New

BC

Toyota Supra

Ben Carter · no activity

New

DB

Mazda RX-7

Direct Buyer · no activity

New

MC

Nissan Skyline

Marcus Chen · no activity

Searching

Who owes money? (0)

Open

No deposits outstanding.

Who's closest to buying? (0)

Open

No one at the deposit stage yet.

My tasks (0)

Open

Nothing due today. Nice.

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- **Needs attention today** — the counts that matter: new leads to contact, auctions closing in 48h, matches to review, follow-ups, stalled requests, deposits outstanding, and tasks.
- **Pipeline strip** — how many requests sit at each stage (New → Delivered).
- **Team overview** — active clients, agents, open requests, cars sent this week.
- **Triage lists** — "Who's gone quiet?", "Which requests are stalled?", "Who owes money?", "Who's closest to buying?" — each links straight to the work.
- **Run Searches** (gold button, bottom of the sidebar) — runs every active saved search against the latest auction lots right now and drops new matches into the review queue. It normally runs automatically on a schedule; this is the manual "do it now" button.

The **sidebar** is your main navigation (Dashboard, Requests, Tasks, Matches, Customers, Auctions, Agents, Payments, Settings) and a **global search** box at the top for finding a customer, vehicle, chassis code or lot fast.

5. Requests — your pipeline

Every customer search is a "request." This page is deliberately simple: the **most recent requests sit at the top**, and each row shows the customer, what they want, the latest car queued for them, the stage, and last activity.

Search customers, vehicle:

Dashboard
Requests 7
Tasks
Matches 3
Customers 8
Auctions
Agents 3
Payments
Settings

Run Searches
JDM Connect ADMIN
Sign out

VEHICLE FINDER

Requests

Every active vehicle search and where it sits in the pipeline.

6 New

0 Qualified

1 Searching

0 Vehicles sent

0 Interested

0 Deposit requested

0 Deposit paid

0 Purchased

0 Shipping

0 Compliance

0 Ready for delivery

0 Delivered

Search requests by customer, vehicle, state or count

Customer	Request	Latest car	Status	Last activity
Marcus Chen REQ-8901	Nissan Skyline BNR34	2001 Nissan Skyline	Searching	no activity
Marcus Chen REQ-8902	Toyota Supra JZA80	1997 Toyota Supra	New	New 3m ago
Aiko Tanaka REQ-9001	Nissan Skyline BNR34	2000 Nissan Skyline	New	New 9h ago
Ben Carter REQ-9002	Toyota Supra JZA80	1997 Toyota Supra	New	New 9h ago
Direct Buyer REQ-9003	Mazda RX-7 FD3S	none yet	New	New 9h ago
Shared Sam REQ-2	Toyota Supra	none yet	New	New 20h ago
Ben Test REQ-1	Nissan Skyline	none yet	New	New 20h ago

KEY TO THE DOTS AND CHIPS

- Click a customer or vehicle to open their **full profile**.
- The **stage dropdown** on each row moves a request along the pipeline (New → Qualified → Searching → Vehicles sent → Interested → Deposit → Purchased → ... → Delivered).
- The stage cards along the top filter the list to one stage.

When a customer taps **"I'm interested"** in their portal, that request jumps to the **Interested** stage here in real time.

6. Matches — review & send cars

The money screen. When a search finds a car, it lands here for you to review before the customer ever sees it.

Each match card shows the car, its **strength** (Strong / Good / Possible), the auction grade, the **landed-cost estimate** (the money figure), and the auction close date. From here you:

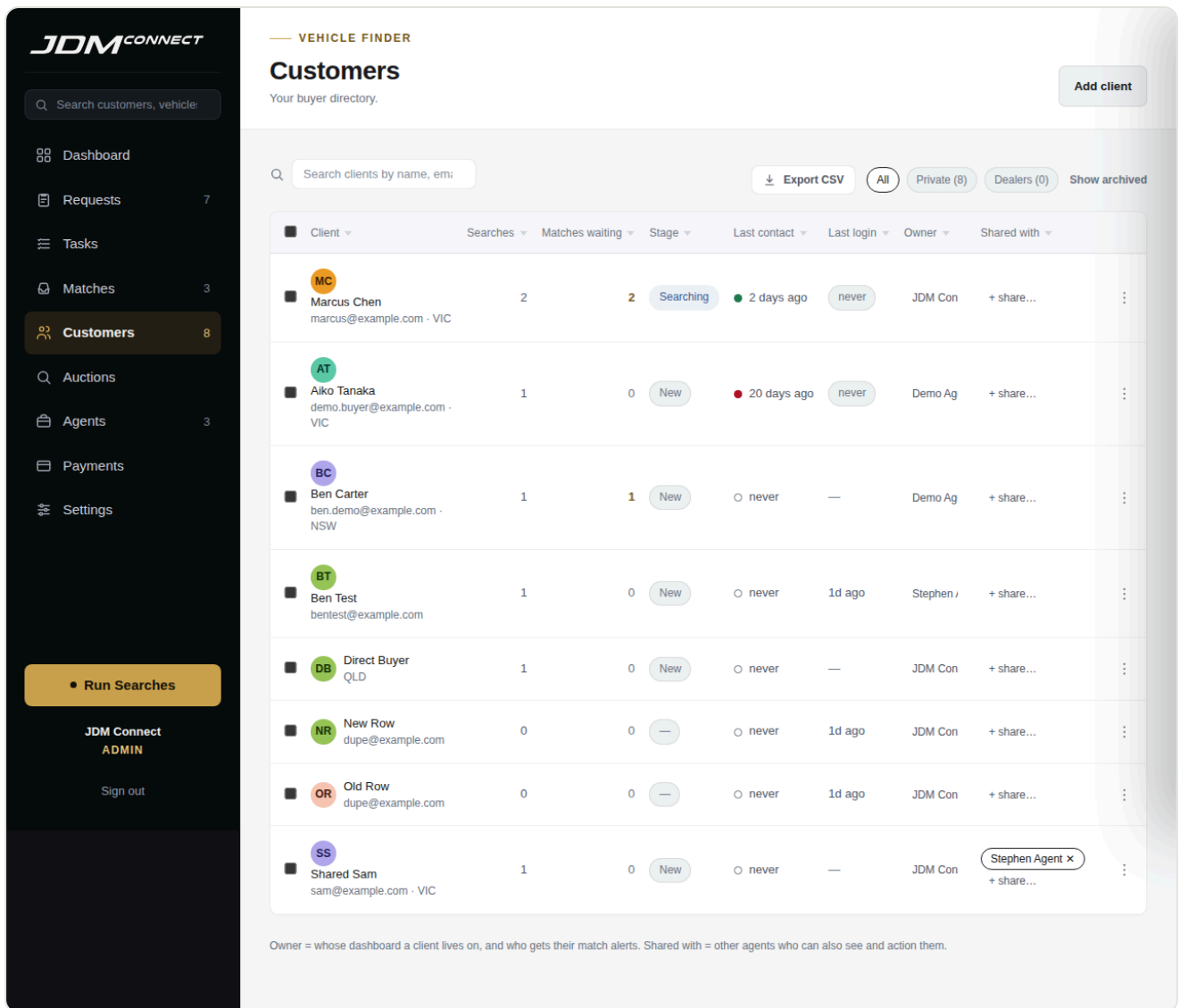
- **Approve & send** — emails (and optionally WhatsApps) the car to the customer.
- **Skip** — removes it from the queue.
- **Select several** and send them as **one combined email** rather than one per car.

Approving is one tap; sending several is select + one tap + confirm.

7. Customers & the client page (Find a car)

Customers list

Your CRM. Find anyone, see how warm they are, and manage who owns them.



Columns show each customer's searches, matches waiting, pipeline stage, last contact, **last login**, owner and who they're shared with. Use the category tabs (All / Private / Dealers) and the search box to narrow the list. Admins can bulk-assign, share or archive from the tick boxes.

The client page — and "Find a car"

Open a customer to see their full record: contact details, engagement stats, their searches, the cars found for them, and their activity timeline.

JDMCONNECT

Q Search customers, vehicle:

Dashboard

Requests

Tasks

Matches2

Customers

Auctions

Agents

Payments

Settings

Run Searches

JDM ConnectADMIN

Sign out

VEHICLE FINDER · CLIENT

Marcus Chen

What they're chasing, and the lots that match.

Back to clients

Marcus Chen

MC

MemberPortal activeVIC

marcus@example.com · +61412345678 · VIC

Last contacted 2d ago · vehicles sent

WhatsApp

Call

Email

Find a car

2Searches

2Live matches

1Examples sent

1Opened

1Interested

2026-07-07Last viewed

-Last login

2Live matches

1 sent this week · 1 opened · 1 interested · last 2d ago

MATCH STRENGTH

Strong

well under budget and a clear step above the grade asked for

Good

a solid fit on budget and grade

Possible

meets the basics, less margin

How it's scored

Select all0 selected

Approve & send

Skip

2001 NISSAN SKYLINE

LANDED VIC A\$142,800

Grade 4.5 · 48k km · BNR34 · 2600cc · Bid ¥9,800,000

Strong

Closes in 532 days USS Tokyo · Lot 51042 for Marcus Chen · Weekend GT-R

Snooze

Skip

Approve & send

BUYER PORTAL

Active - client can sign in

Resend set-password link

Send password reset

Revoke

MEMBERSHIP

Member · can use Auction search

Remove member access

Edit details

+

Activity

No activity yet.

1Sent and past cars

What Marcus has already been sent, whether they opened it, and their response.

2000 Nissan Skyline

Chassis BNR34 · 58,000 km · Grade 4 · 2027-12-19 · A\$121,000 landed

Interested

sent 2d ago

Interested

Pass

2Searches

Weekend GT-R

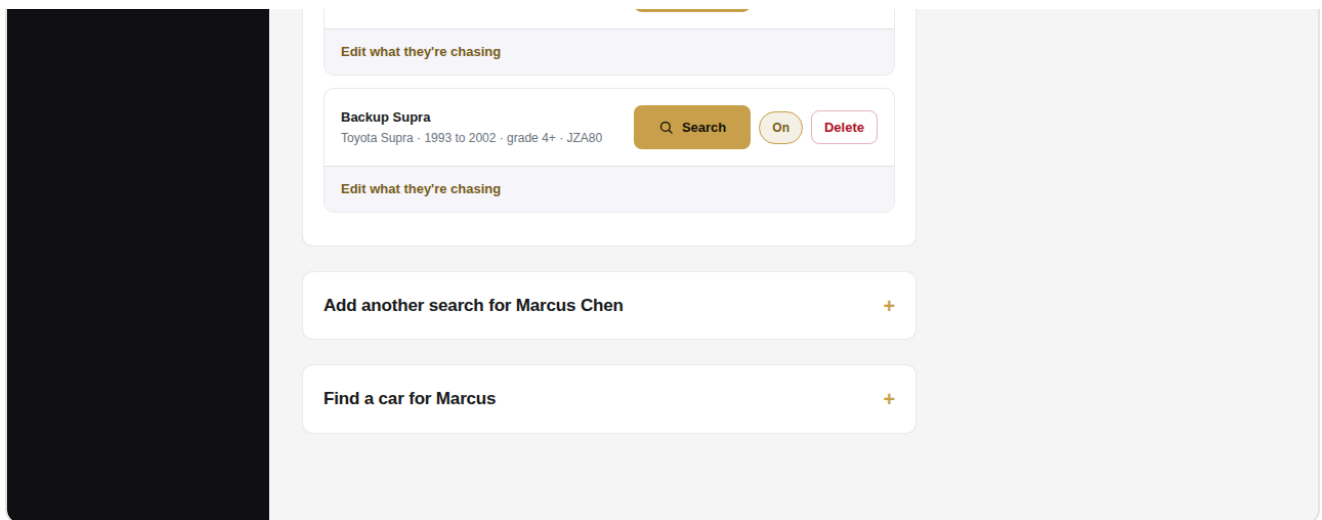
Nissan Skyline · 1999 to 2002 · grade 4+ · BNR34

Q Search

On

Delete

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The screenshot shows a user interface for finding vehicles. On the left is a dark vertical sidebar. The main area contains a search card for 'Backup Supra', which includes the text 'Toyota Supra · 1993 to 2002 · grade 4+ · JZA80'. To the right of this text are three buttons: a gold 'Search' button with a magnifying glass icon, a yellow 'On' button, and a red 'Delete' button. Above and below the search card are light blue bars with the text 'Edit what they're chasing'. Below the search card are two more buttons: 'Add another search for Marcus Chen' and 'Find a car for Marcus', both with a plus icon on the right.

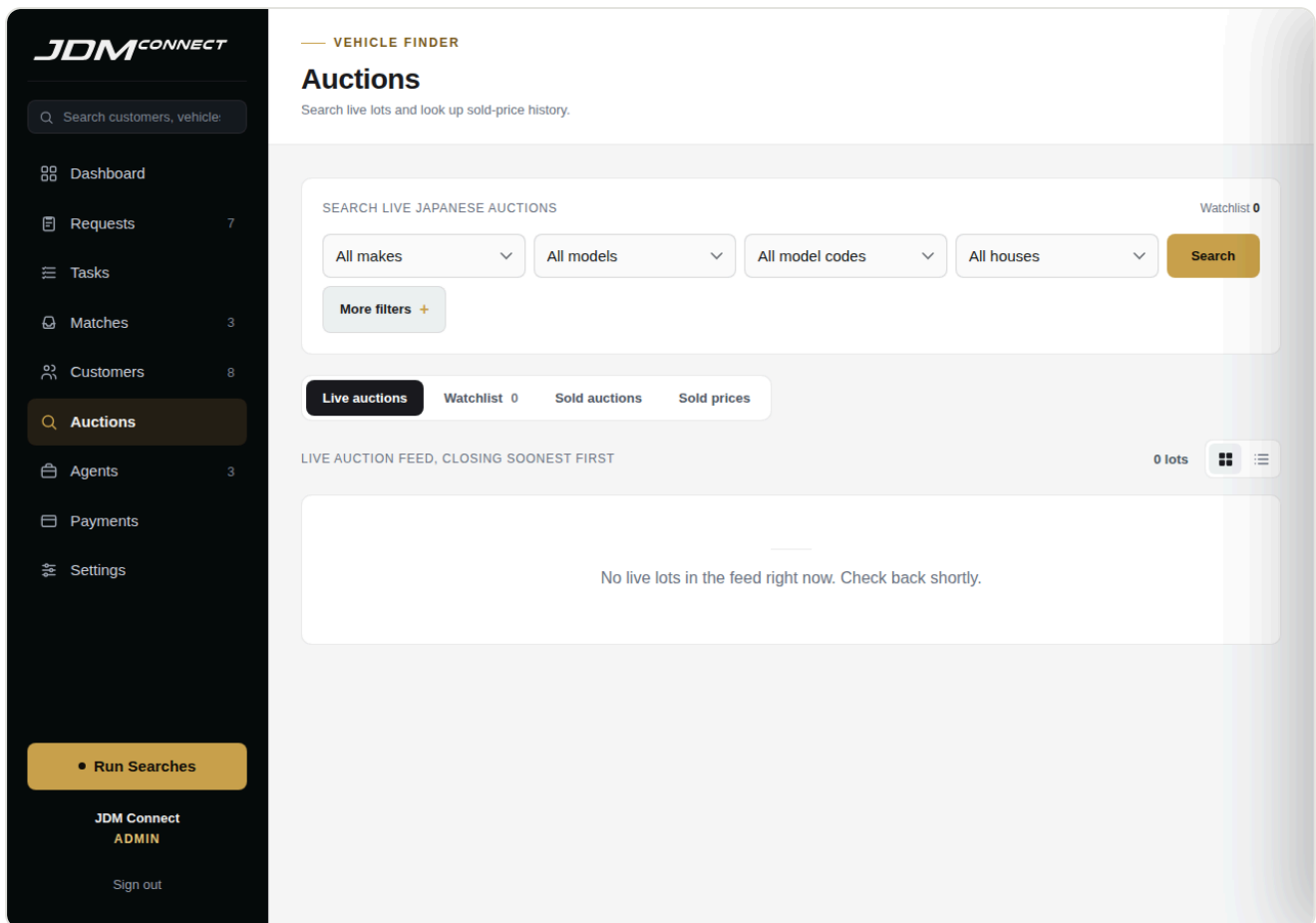
The key tool here is **Find a car** (the gold button / the `#find` card). It runs a **live auction search for this specific customer**: search the Japanese auctions, and add any lot straight to their review queue with one click. It pre-fills from the customer's saved search so you don't retype it.

This search form now appears for **any staff member who can see the customer** — the owning agent, an agent the customer is shared with, or you. (Editing contact details and portal access stay owner/admin-only.)

Buyer portal controls on this page let you give a customer portal access (emails them a set-password link), resend it, revoke it, or make them a paid **Member**.

8. Auctions — searching the live feed

A standalone workspace to search the live Japanese auctions and look up sold-price history, independent of any one customer.



- **Filters:** Make, Model, **Model code**, and Auction house. Changing a filter **no longer fires the search instantly** — it refills the dependent dropdowns in the background and waits for you to press **Search**, so you can set up all your filters first. "More filters" adds year, price and grade.
- **Tabs:** Live auctions · Watchlist · Sold auctions · Sold prices.
- **Result cards** show the car, grade, eligibility, auction house and price, with a **Sheet** button when the inspection sheet is available. Tick a card to select it for a client; click anywhere else on the card to open its full listing.
- The **auction house list is built from the live feed itself**, so houses that only appear on auction day (e.g. USS JAA) show up automatically.

Model codes & grades (precise variant targeting)

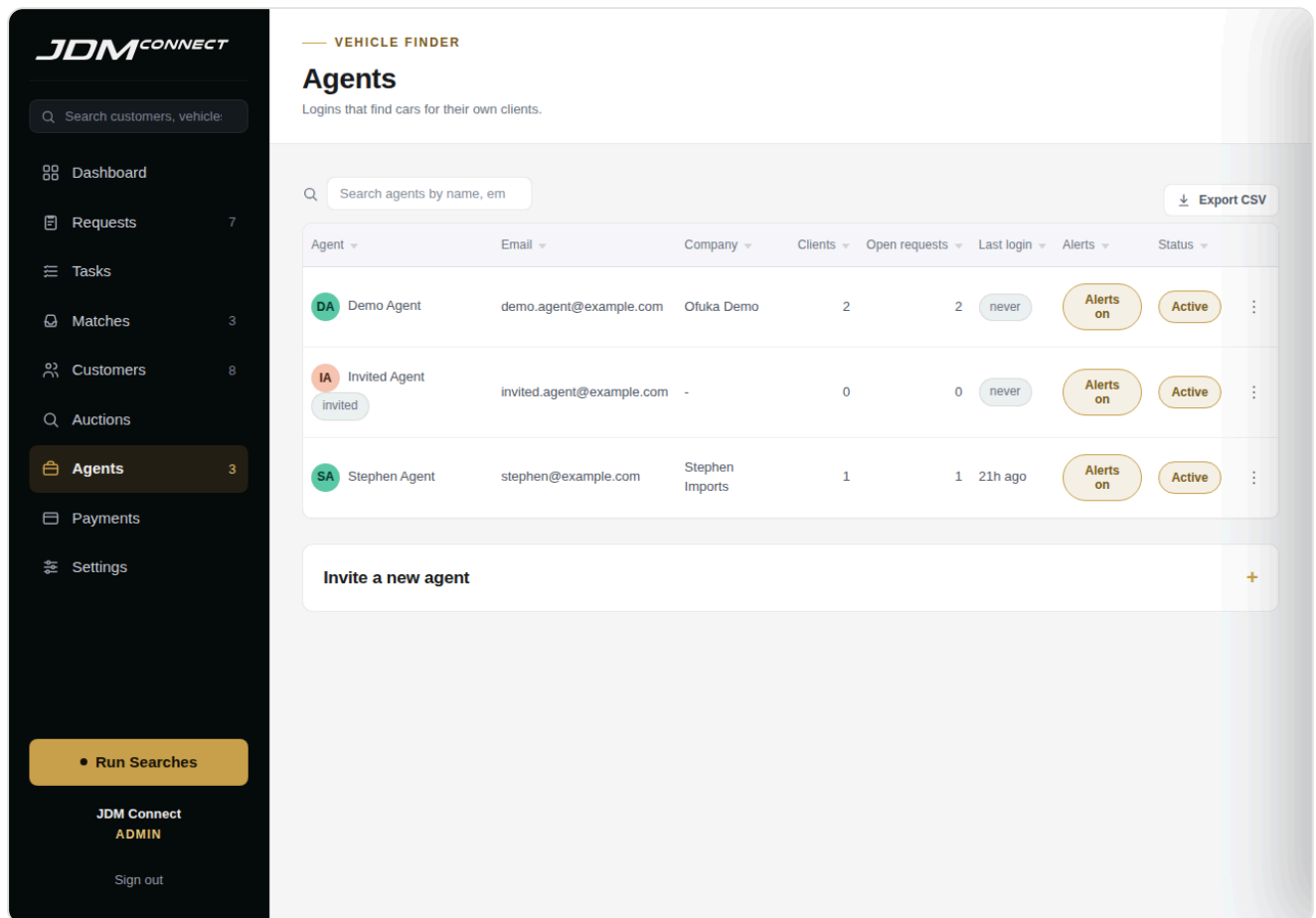
Make + Model isn't enough for many cars (a Mercedes S-Class hides the S450; a Crown spans four very different variants). So searches can also carry:

- **Model code** — the chassis/model code, shown with a friendly label (e.g. BNR34 - Skyline GT-R (R34)), pulled from the feed for the chosen make.
- **Grade** — pick every spelling of the variant grade you'd accept (auction houses spell the same grade many ways); they're matched together.

These appear on the public wizard, the admin "Add a search" form, and the buyer portal. When set, the matcher narrows precisely to them; when left blank, matching behaves exactly as before.

9. Agents

Manage the partner logins who find cars for their own buyers.



The screenshot displays the 'Agents' management interface within the JDM Connect Vehicle Finder. The left sidebar contains navigation links: Dashboard, Requests (7), Tasks, Matches (3), Customers (8), Auctions, Agents (3), Payments, and Settings. The main content area is titled 'Agents' and includes a search bar for agents by name or email, an 'Export CSV' button, and a table of agent details.

Agent	Email	Company	Clients	Open requests	Last login	Alerts	Status
DA Demo Agent	demo.agent@example.com	Ofuka Demo	2	2	never	Alerts on	Active
IA Invited Agent	invited.agent@example.com	-	0	0	never	Alerts on	Active
SA Stephen Agent	stephen@example.com	Stephen Imports	1	1	21h ago	Alerts on	Active

Below the table is a button labeled 'Invite a new agent' with a plus icon.

Each agent row shows their **client count**, **open requests**, and **last login**, plus toggles for alerts and active/paused status. "Invite a new agent" emails them a link to set their own password; from then on they see only their own (and shared) customers and matches.

10. Settings

Everything you can change without a developer — grouped into cards, with a jump nav at the top.

JDMCONNECT

Q

Search customers, vehicle:

Dashboard

Requests

7

Tasks

Matches

3

Customers

8

Auctions

Agents

3

Payments

Settings

• Run Searches

JDM Connect

ADMIN

Sign out

VEHICLE FINDER

Settings

Manage alerts, client-facing pricing, payments and AI reading.

Notifications

WhatsApp

Client-facing

Payments

Pricing

Free tier

Landed cost

AI reader

1 Notifications

Alert email (where new-match alerts are sent)

support@jdmconnect.com.au

☒

Email me new vehicle requests

Email me when someone submits the public request form.

☒

Email me match alerts

Send a digest email when new matches are found.

☒

Email matches to clients on approval

Email the car to the client when you approve a match.

Send me a test email

Verifies the channel end to end, to the alert email above (save first if you changed it).

2 WhatsApp · auto-send matches

☒ Send matches to clients on WhatsApp

When you approve a match, also WhatsApp it to the client if they gave a number.

Provider

Twilio

Test number (yours, +61...)

+61 4XX XXX X

Send a test WhatsApp

3 Client-facing visibility

☒ Show landed (AUD) price to clients

Show the indicative AUD landed price to clients.

☐ Show recent market average to clients

Show the recent market-average price to clients (members).

4 Payments · Stripe

Take a deposit from buyers in their portal. No Stripe key set yet -deposits stay off until the STRIPE_SECRET_KEY secret is added.

☐ Enable deposits in the buyer portal

Show a "Pay deposit" button on cars a client asked us to chase.

Deposit amount (AUD)

e.g. 500

Currency

aud

Webhook setup

5 Membership

The "Full access" plan, billed monthly via Stripe. Turn it on to show a Subscribe button in the buyer portal (needs the STRIPE_SECRET_KEY secret first). An active subscription makes the client a member automatically.

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☒ **Sell Full access in the portal**
 Show the "Get full access" subscribe button to non-members.

Full access (A\$/month)

 Free result limit (reserved)

5c Free tier & search runs

How free accounts behave, and whose searches "Run Searches" covers. Change these any time, no deploy needed.

☒ **Auto-send the first match to free signups**
 On: a free account gets an example match emailed the instant they sign up. Off (recommended): staff review matches before they are sent.

☒ **Run Searches includes free accounts**
 On (recommended): the matcher runs every active search, free or paid. Off: it runs paid members' searches only.

Active searches per free account

5b Landed cost assumptions

The figures behind every landed-price estimate on listings and emails. Change them here and new estimates use them straight away, no deploy needed. Leave a field blank to use the built-in default.

Compliance (A\$, SEVS/RAWS)

 Agency fee (A\$, per import)

FX override (JPY per A\$, blank = live rate)

Shipping, duties and on-road costs come from the live landed-cost calculator per state and port. When an estimate can't be produced for a lot, the figure is hidden rather than guessed.

6 AI auction-sheet reader

Reads the Japanese inspection sheet from a car's photos. **No API key set yet** -the reader stays off until the ANTHROPIC_API_KEY secret is added.

When to read

 Model (cached per car)

How auto-read works

- **Notifications** — the alert email address and which emails go out (staff digest, new-request alerts, match-on-approval to clients).
- **WhatsApp** — turn on WhatsApp delivery of matches and choose the provider.
- **Client-facing** — whether customers see the landed cost and market price.
- **Payments** — Stripe deposits: enable, set the amount and currency, webhook.
- **Pricing** — the Full Access membership price and the free result limit.
- **Free tier & search runs (new)** — two switches, changeable any time:
 - *Auto-send the first match to free signups* — **off by default**, so staff review matches before they're sent.

- *Run Searches includes free accounts* — **on by default**, so the matcher runs everyone's searches, not just paid members.
- Plus the number of active searches a free account may keep (default 1).
- **Landed cost assumptions** (*new*) — edit the compliance cost, agency fee and an FX override that feed every landed-price estimate, with no deploy needed. (Shipping, duties and on-road costs still come from the live calculator per state. If an accurate figure can't be produced for a lot, the figure is hidden rather than shown wrong.)
- **AI auction-sheet reader** — reads the Japanese inspection sheet from a car's photos; choose when it runs and which model.

Changes are saved with the sticky **Save settings** bar; you're warned if you try to leave with unsaved edits.

11. The buyer portal (what your customers see)

When you give a customer portal access, this is their view. Clean, simple, and focused on the cars you've found for them.

JDMCONNECT

Your garage

Auction search

Sold auctions

Marcus Chen
MEMBER

Sign out

YOUR GARAGE

Welcome, Marcus

The cars we've found for you, and the searches we're running.

Sign out

NEW FOR YOU

1

Matches waiting on your go-ahead

CARS FOUND

1

Hand-reviewed for your searches

IN PROGRESS

0

We're chasing these for you

ACTIVE SEARCHES

2

Running on every auction sweep

FULL ACCESS

You're a member

Unlimited searches and priority sourcing on every match. Thank you.

Cars we've found for you

1

Hand-reviewed by our team and matched to your search. Tap "Ask us to get this" and we'll pull the auction sheet, translate it, and come back to you.

Lot 22910

2000 Nissan Skyline

USS Nagoya - 2027-12-19

YEAR	GRADE	ODOMETER	AUCTION EST.
2000	4	58k	¥8,600,000

Grade 4+ Chassis BNR34

INDICATIVE LANDED · VIC

A\$121,000

Weekend GT-R

Ask us to get this

What you're searching for

2/2

Edit a search or add another - changes apply on the next auction sweep.

Weekend GT-R

Nissan Skyline · 1999 to 2002 · grade 4+ · BNR34

On Delete

Edit this search

Backup Supra

Toyota Supra · 1993 to 2002 · grade 4+ · JZA80

On Delete

Edit this search

Add a search

+

- **Your garage** — a stat strip (new for you, cars found, in progress, active searches), and the **cars we've found for you**, each with the vehicle, grade, odometer, auction estimate and the

indicative landed price. The card links through to the full listing. **"Ask us to get this"** flags the car — which drops it onto your Requests page as *Interested* in real time.

- **What you're searching for** — their saved searches, which they can edit, pause, delete, or add to (free accounts are limited to one active search; members are unlimited).
- **Members** also get **Auction search** and **Sold auctions** in the sidebar, to browse the live floor themselves.

Non-members see an upgrade prompt for **Full Access**; the Subscribe flow lands on a real page (with the price and a subscribe button, or an honest note if online purchase isn't available yet).

12. Everyday workflows — quick reference

A new lead came in → Dashboard shows it under "New leads to contact." Open the request, call/message the customer, move the stage to *Qualified*.

Find a car for a customer → Open the customer → **Find a car** → search the auctions → add the best lots to their queue → go to **Matches** → *Approve & send*.

A customer said they're interested → It appears on **Requests** as *Interested* automatically (from their portal). Chase the deposit; move the stage along as you go.

Reset someone's password → Tell them to use **Forgot password?** on the login page, or trigger it from their record. New agents/customers get a set-password link by email.

Give a customer portal access → Open the customer → **Give portal access** (needs an email on file). To make them a paying member, use **Make member**.

Add a partner agent → Settings-adjacent **Agents** → *Invite a new agent* → assign or share customers to them so they show up in that agent's login.

Change how free accounts behave, or the landed-cost figures → **Settings** → **Free tier** and **Settings** → **Landed cost**. No deploy needed.

Questions or something not behaving as described? The behaviour above matches the live site as deployed. If a screen looks different, do a hard refresh (Ctrl/Cmd + Shift + R) to clear a cached older version.